| THE POINT |

THE SALARY DIVIDE

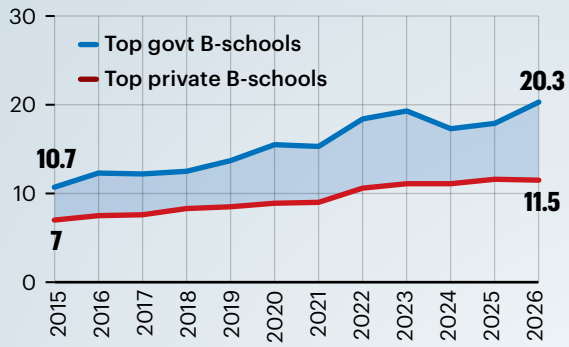
India's booming management education sector is facing a structural divergence in salary outcomes between elite institutions and lower-ranked B-schools. The divergence was driven by a rise in average salaries at the top 10, even as salaries at schools ranked 76–100 declined, reversing the narrowing seen a year earlier.

By **Ujjwal Thakur**
Graphic by **Tanmoy Chakraborty**

GOVERNMENT SCHOOLS GAIN GROUND

Average salaries of government B-school graduates climbed steadily to ₹20.3 lakh in 2026, while private B-schools saw little movement

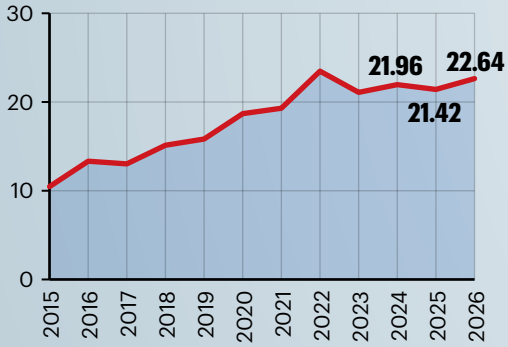
Average salary offered at govt vs private B-schools (₹lakh per annum)



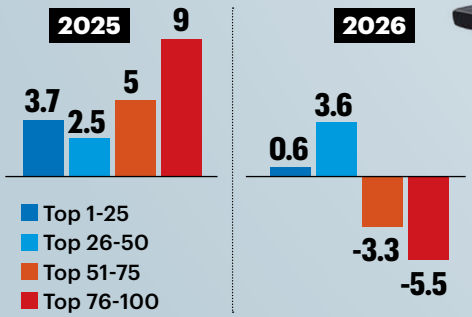
ELITES GAIN, LOWER TIERS LAG

Salary growth has weakened sharply among lower-ranked B-schools, with average salaries falling 3.3% for Rank 51–75 and 5.5% for Rank 76–100 in 2026. In contrast, the Top 10 continued to command significantly higher salaries

Salary gap between top 10 and top 76-100 (₹ lakh)



Salary growth among B-schools (% change YoY)





₹18.03 LAKH

The average course fee (tuition plus other fees) charged by top 100 government B-schools in 2026, compared to ₹13.05 lakh at their private counterparts